

Michael Vargo

330.692.3375 | vargo.mb@gmail.com | Columbus, OH

LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/mbvargo | Personal Website: mbvargo.github.io

PROFESSIONAL OVERVIEW

City planner and data researcher with experience in transportation planning, environmental analysis, GIS, and policy evaluation. Proficient planner, public communicator, and data analyst seeking opportunities in land use policy, transportation, and strategic planning.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant | The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH Jan 2026 – May 2026

- Course design, student assessment, and in-class instruction on topics related to land use and transportation, including demand modeling, transit-oriented development, and sprawl.

Travel Demand Modeling Intern | Ohio Dept. of Transportation, Columbus, OH May 2025 – Dec 2025

- Developed R tools that standardized analysis of more than 20 years of statewide travel forecast data, enabling future accuracy assessments.
- Authored ODOT's first comprehensive report on statewide forecast accuracy in 11 years. This work detailed trends in forecast error and offered recommendations for data governance.
- Supported FHWA research into forecast performance through testing and input on new methods to facilitate accuracy assessments by states and MPOs nationwide.

Teaching Assistant | Académie de Strasbourg, Guebwiller, France Oct 2022 – April 2023

- Led course design, assessment, and in-class instruction for groups of 15 to 25 students.
- Engaged students in English language instruction through activity-based learning, individual tutoring, interdisciplinary lessons, and cultural activities.

EDUCATION

Master of City & Regional Planning | Knowlton School, The Ohio State University 2024 – 2026

Arabic – Intermediate-Advanced (3.5) | Middlebury Language School 2022

Bachelor of Arts in Arabic, French, Political Science | The Ohio State University 2017 – 2021

RECOGNITION

Knowlton School's Hazel Morrow Jones Award for Outstanding Graduate Student 2025, 2026

SKILLS

Document Design Adobe InDesign, Canva, knitr, Quarto, Word
Graphic Design Adobe Illustrator, Canva, Inkscape
Web Design Quarto, Github Pages, Basic HTML, CSS, and JS

2/3D Modeling Sketchup, Rayshader
Data Analysis Tidyverse, OLS & spatial models, Pandas, Excel
Data Visualization ggplot2, Plotly, knitr, Shiny, Matplotlib, ArcGIS Insights
GIS and Cartography ArcGIS Pro, ESRI Suite, QGIS, R-Spatial, GeoPandas
Programming Github, Python, R, basic SQL

Stakeholder Engagement Public speaking, stakeholder interviews
Planning and Policy Critical writing, policy evaluation, research, site assessment

Languages English, French (C1-C2), Arabic (B1), Portuguese (Reading)